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Friday, 8th May 2009

The UK Independence Party believes that the UK should withdraw from the European Union and that our membership should be replaced with a genuine free trade agreement similar to those enjoyed by other non-EU nations such as Switzerland, Norway and Mexico.

We want friendship and free trade with our European neighbours – not political union.

Jobs

Our membership of the European Union is already costing jobs in the UK. Major construction projects now hire many of their staff overseas, with British workers not even having the opportunity to apply. This is not the 'British jobs for British workers' the Government promised.

Immigration

The only people who should decide who can come to live, work and settle in Britain should be the British people themselves. We can only do this outside of the EU political union. The open-door immigration policy has been voted against by only one party – UKIP.

Trade

The UK has one of the largest economies in the world. We are an international trading nation, not just a European one.

The European Union is designed to meet the challenges of the 1950s, not those of the 21st Century. In the global economy in which we now live, we should not be focussing on the insular regional trading blocs, but opening our arms to trade with the rest of the world, starting with the Commonwealth.

Agriculture & Fisheries

When Britain joined the then Common Market, the price of membership was handing over control of our agricultural and fisheries policies and the surrender of our fishing grounds. This has proved to be an ecological disaster, with common European policies driving farmers to financial ruin and devastating the marine environment around our isles. Leaving the EU will allow us to regain control and put British interests ahead of European interests.

The EU Constitution

The British people were promised a referendum on the EU Constitution, now the Government has reneged on this promise.

The original constitution was rejected by voters in France and Holland. The Lisbon Treaty, which is the European Constitution in disguise, has been rejected by the Irish in a referendum.

The Government is determined not to allow your voice to be heard.

A vote for UKIP is a vote to say 'No' loudly and clearly. It may be the last chance you get. UKIP is committed to a free, democratic, independent Britain which is governed not by the faceless bureaucrats in Brussels but by our own people through our elected Parliament at Westminster.

We believe that British taxpayers' money should be spent on British taxpayers, on their schools, hospitals and pensions.

Just imagine what we could achieve if the £15bn cost of our membership of the EU was spent here, rather than being lost on fraud and corruption in Brussels

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